# Statistical Architecture Framework

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SAF is a shared way for national statistical offices to describe how they turn data into official statistics, and to change how they do it while keeping production running.

It is written for the people who do that work: methodologists, statisticians, data and IT staff, quality and privacy officers, managers and CIOs. You do not need a background in architecture to read this site or the framework itself.

> Where to start
>
> If you have ten minutes, read **SAF in Brief**. To try SAF on one of your own statistical products, read **Getting Started** and do the exercise at the end. Use the **Framework** as a reference afterwards.

### The four routes in

Table 1: The four routes in

| | What it answers | Reading time |
|---|---|---|
| **SAF in Brief** | What is SAF, what are its two core ideas, and what would adopting it give my office and commit us to? | about 10 minutes |
| **Getting Started with SAF** | What does this look like on real data? A labour force survey and a tax register are followed from collection to publication, and an exercise helps you map one of your own processes. | about 30 minutes, plus the exercise |
| **SAF Architecture Framework** | The full framework in chapters: motivation and principles, the capability model, and one chapter for each of the ten value streams. | read by chapter |
| **Glossary** | What does SAF mean by *artefact*, *steady state*, *lineage*, *registered*? | as needed |

### The one idea worth knowing first

SAF splits statistical production into stages that pass data to each other at agreed points called **steady states**. At each of these points the data has reached a known quality, has a version and an identifier, and comes with a description of what was done to it. The stage that picks it up does not need to know anything else about how the previous stage works.

Because of this, an office can modernise one part of its production (a collection channel, an editing engine, a publication platform) without disrupting the others. It can also show how any published figure was produced.

The formal model behind all of this is available in ArchiMate format.